

# MCP in *plain English*

MCP is one of the most common words thrown around in GTM right now. Yet, it is rarely explained in simple terms. This is the starting point: understand it first, then trust it, use it and stretch it.

## 01 What it is

MCP (Model Context Protocol) is a standard that lets AI tools like Claude or ChatGPT connect to other systems and use them, without every integration being built from scratch.

The MCP team describes it as “a USB-C port for AI applications.” [Source](#)

### PICTURE IT

USB - C

Phone

Laptop

Headphones



One port

MCP

Claude

ChatGPT

Copilot



One standard

## 02 How it works

One question, four steps.

1 YOU

### Ask in plain English

“Catch me up on Halden Freight.”

2 AI TOOL

### Claude, Copilot and others

Understands the ask and picks the right Backstory tool.

3 MCP

### The standard connection

Carries the request using your Backstory permissions.

4 BACKSTORY

### Sends back summaries

Of the emails, meetings and CRM activity it has captured.

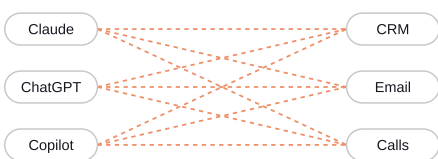
↩ The answer comes back inside the AI tool you already use.

## 03 Why a standard matters

Build once, use everywhere.

BEFORE MCP

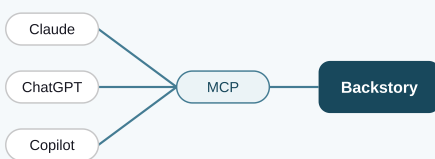
9 custom builds



Every AI tool needed its own connection to every system. Three tools and three systems meant nine builds to maintain.

WITH MCP

1 connection



Backstory builds one MCP server. Every AI tool that speaks MCP can use it, including ones your team adds later.

### THE TAKEAWAY FOR GTM TEAMS

#### Context where you work

Ask about an account and get answers from Backstory, without switching tabs.

#### Connect once

One server works across the AI clients your team already uses.

#### Answers stay grounded

The AI works from summaries of the emails, meetings and CRM activity Backstory captures.

OVERLEAF 4 · Ask it like this →

see what's coming know what to do

4 START HERE

## Three kinds of *questions*

You never pick a tool. Claude does. What matters is which kind of question you ask and where each one stops. Swap in a real account and try one.

1 · ONE ACCOUNT OR DEAL

“Catch me up on Halden Freight.”

REP, AM/CSM

“Any risks on the Halden Freight renewal deal?”

REP, MANAGER

**Good to know:** Covers the last 30 days. Use the full company name and check it in the first answer.

2 · A LIST

“Using Backstory, what deals do I have closing this quarter?”

REP

“Which of my team’s deals closing this quarter have engagement under 50?”

MANAGER, VP

**Good to know:** Backstory says how it read the question. Check it says *your* deals and the right window.

3 · BACKSTORY’S ASSISTANT

“Ask Backstory’s assistant what the big themes have been with Halden Freight over the last 90 days.”

VP

**Good to know:** Start with “Ask Backstory’s assistant” for anything older than 30 days. It is most reliable for the last 30 days.



HABIT

Start a new chat for each new question. Long chats are more likely to make mistakes.

## 5 Example: Similar deals

Comparable deals to learn from.

### WHAT IT DOES

Finds similar deals at other customers. You may get a different set each time.

### WHERE TO FIND IT

MCP only. Not exposed anywhere else in Backstory.

### STATUS

In pilot. Matches can include open deals, so treat them as examples, not a playbook.

### WHY IT MATTERS FOR GTM

Reps get comparable deals to learn from. Managers can coach from real examples instead of memory.

Have we had a deal like the Halden Freight renewal before? How'd it go?

Loaded tools, used Backstory MCP integration >

I found similar deals at other customers. Here's the closest match and what stood out.

#### Closest match: a renewal at a mid-market logistics company

Similar shape: a multi-year renewal, a new budget owner, and pricing that needed rework before signature.

#### What stood out

- Separated subscription pricing from services pricing, which cleared up buyer confusion
- Ran a technical alignment session so stakeholders had what they needed for sign-off
- Sent the order form the moment approvals cleared

**Note:** Two other matches are still open. Ask again and you may see a different set.

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE · MOCK DATA

OVERLEAF 6 · What it means for your team →

see what's coming know what to do

## 6 What it means for your team

## Your AI becomes an expert on *your* business

BEFORE MCP

- ✗ Copy account data out of Backstory, paste it into a chat, get generic advice
- ✗ Ask vague questions with no context behind them
- ✗ Switch between tools all day
- ✗ Analyze and report on data by hand

WITH MCP

- Your AI tool pulls summaries of your accounts and deals from the last 30 days
- Ask specific questions: “Any risks on the Halden Freight renewal deal?”
- Get insights based on your actual data, not generic best practices
- Work faster without leaving your AI tool

## 7 Why it works

What happens behind each answer.

### One standard, any client

Backstory exposes one server. You connect whichever AI client your team already lives in.

### Current data, real permissions

Answers are up to date with what Backstory has captured. Each person sees what their Backstory user sees.

### No copy, paste and hope

Instead of pasting a summary into a chat and hoping it's current, the AI pulls Backstory's summaries itself.

## 8 Good to know

### WHAT IT DOESN'T DO

- ✗ Replace human judgment or relationships
- ✗ Change anything in Backstory or your CRM. It only reads.
- ✗ Work well if Backstory data isn't up to date
- ✗ Replace a good sales process

### QUICK ANSWERS

#### Do we need to change how we work?

No. Keep using Backstory as you do today. MCP gives your AI tools access to that data.

#### What does it cost?

MCP is included with your Backstory subscription. The AI tools themselves may have their own cost.

### WORKS WITH

Claude

ChatGPT

Microsoft Copilot

Google Gemini

n8n

Setup guides for each are in the [Help Center](#).

## 9 Habits that keep answers right

01

### Check the company name

Short names can match the wrong account.

02

### New chat, new question

Long chats are more likely to make mistakes.

03

### Answers cover 30 days

Say so when you share an analysis.

04

### Thin isn't "nothing"

The activity may not have been captured.

## 10 Getting started

### Take stock

Which AI tools does your team already use?

### Pick use cases

Which prompts above would save the most time?

### Connect

Work with Backstory to set up MCP.

### Train

Teach the three kinds of questions and the habits above.

### Measure

Track time saved and answer quality.

UP NEXT The First 15 Minutes

see what's coming know what to do